

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Exterior & Commercial Cleaning Services

CAIRNS BIN CLEANING

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ABN: 36 318 413 406

Servicing Cairns and the Far North Queensland region

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1. Purpose & Scope

This Safe Work Method Statement (SWMS) describes how Cairns Bin Cleaning identifies and controls the hazards involved in delivering its exterior and commercial cleaning services. It is provided to clients, site principal contractors, strata and body corporate managers, and government/commercial procurement contacts as evidence of a documented approach to work health and safety.

This SWMS covers the following services as offered by Cairns Bin Cleaning:

- Wheelie bin cleaning and sanitisation (residential, strata, commercial)
- Pressure washing / pressure cleaning of driveways, paths, patios and hard surfaces
- House washing (exterior building surfaces, walls, eaves)
- Soft washing (low-pressure chemical treatment of roofs, walls and cladding)
- Roof cleaning
- Gutter cleaning
- Solar panel cleaning
- Window cleaning (interior and exterior, ground and low-rise access)
- Driveway, fence and pool deck cleaning

This document is a live SWMS: it is reviewed before work commences on any site with unusual or additional hazards not covered here (e.g. multi-storey access, confined spaces, asbestos-containing materials, live services), and updated at minimum annually or after any incident, near-miss, regulatory change, or change to the services offered.

2. Legislative & Reference Framework

- Work Health and Safety Act 2011 (Qld)
- Work Health and Safety Regulation 2011 (Qld)
- Workers' Compensation and Rehabilitation Act 2003 (Qld) — current WorkCover Qld Certificate of Currency held (Policy WSM250967591, industry classification 731114 — Building & Other Industrial Cleaning Services)
- Public and products liability insurance held — \$20,000,000 limit of liability (Elders Insurance / QBE, Policy EGU627053BPK)
- Safe Work Australia Code of Practice: Managing the Risk of Falls at Workplaces
- Safe Work Australia Code of Practice: Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace
- Australian/New Zealand Standard AS/NZS 1892 (Portable ladders)
- Manufacturer operating instructions for all pressure washing and access equipment

3. Roles & Responsibilities

Siezar Fransiscus Dewaal, as sole trader and principal operator of Cairns Bin Cleaning, is responsible for:

- Ensuring this SWMS is followed on every job and reviewed before work involving hazards not addressed in it
- Providing and maintaining PPE, plant and equipment in safe working order
- Holding and maintaining current WorkCover Qld and public liability insurance
- Briefing any subcontracted or additional labour on this SWMS before work begins, and stopping work where a new hazard is identified that is not covered
- Reporting and investigating any incident or near-miss, and updating this SWMS where it reveals a gap in controls

On any site where a principal contractor, site manager, strata manager or property manager has their own site-specific WHS requirements or induction, those requirements are followed in addition to this SWMS.

4. General Controls — All Tasks

The following controls apply across every job regardless of the specific service being delivered:

- Visual site assessment completed on arrival: identify pedestrian and vehicle traffic, overhead powerlines, pets, children, uneven ground, existing damage, and any site-specific hazards before starting work
- Appropriate PPE worn at all times: closed, non-slip footwear; eye protection when using pressure equipment or chemicals; gloves suited to the task (chemical-resistant for chemical handling, cut-resistant for bin handling); sun protection (hat, sunscreen, UV-rated clothing) for FNQ conditions; hearing protection where equipment noise requires it

- Work is rescheduled or stopped during severe weather — electrical storms, heavy rain, or high wind — particularly for any roof, gutter or elevated work
- Manual handling: bins, equipment and materials are lifted using correct technique (bend knees, keep load close, avoid twisting); mechanical aids (bin trolleys, wheels) used wherever available rather than manual carrying
- First aid kit and mobile phone carried on every job for emergency contact
- Vehicle parked to minimise reversing and positioned to protect the immediate work area from through-traffic where the job is street-facing
- Only biodegradable, environmentally-approved cleaning chemicals are used, applied per manufacturer Safety Data Sheet (SDS) instructions; SDS carried in the work vehicle for all chemicals in use
- All wastewater from pressure washing and bin cleaning is contained using onboard wastewater storage / recovery equipment rather than allowed to run uncontrolled into stormwater drains, garden beds or waterways

5. Plant & Equipment Register

- Petrol/diesel or electric pressure washer units (vehicle or trailer-mounted)
- Wheelie bin cleaning unit with onboard wastewater recovery and containment tank
- Extension poles and low-level access equipment for window and gutter cleaning
- Portable ladders (compliant with AS/NZS 1892) for low-level roof, gutter and window access
- Soft-wash chemical application equipment
- Hoses, fittings and trigger guns rated to the pressure washer's operating pressure

All plant is visually inspected before each use (hoses for splits/wear, fittings for security, ladders for damage) and any defective item is tagged out and removed from service until repaired or replaced.

6. Task-Specific Risk Assessments

Risk ratings below follow a standard Likelihood × Consequence matrix (Low / Medium / High / Extreme). Where the residual rating after controls remains Medium or above, the task is not commenced without the specific control being in place and confirmed.

6.1 Wheelie Bin Cleaning

Task Step	Hazard / Risk	Rating	Control Measures	Residual
Presenting / collecting bins	Manual handling — back/shoulder strain from lifting or wheeling full or heavy bins	MEDIUM	Use bin's own wheels to roll rather than lift; correct manual handling technique; mechanical bin-lift on cleaning unit used rather than manual tipping	LOW
Cleaning bin interior	Biological hazard — bacteria, mould, odour, and sharps/hazardous items left in bins by others	MEDIUM	Puncture-resistant gloves worn; visual check of bin contents before mechanical cleaning; hand hygiene / sanitiser after each job; any sharps found are not handled by hand and are reported to the customer	LOW
Bin cleaning wastewater	Environmental — contaminated wastewater entering stormwater or gardens	MEDIUM	Onboard wastewater containment and recovery system used for all bin cleaning; no direct discharge to stormwater drains	LOW
Working roadside / in driveways	Traffic — struck by moving vehicle while presenting or returning bins	HIGH	Hi-vis clothing worn when working near live traffic; bins presented and returned facing away from traffic flow; vehicle positioned to shield the work area where the street layout allows	LOW

6.2 Pressure Washing — Driveways, Paths, Fences, Pool Decks

Task Step	Hazard / Risk	Rating	Control Measures	Residual
Operating pressure washer	High-pressure water injection injury to skin/eyes from direct contact with the jet	HIGH	Operator trained in safe trigger-gun use; jet never directed at self, bystanders, or unprotected body parts; minimum safe standoff distance maintained; eye protection worn	LOW

Task Step	Hazard / Risk	Rating	Control Measures	Residual
Working near power points / switchboards	Electric shock from water contact with electrical fittings	HIGH	Visual check for exposed electrical fittings before starting; power points and switchboards avoided or isolated where accessible; RCD-protected equipment used	LOW
Flying debris	Eye or skin injury from dislodged grit, stones or surface material	MEDIUM	Eye protection worn; bystanders and pets kept clear of the work area; work area barriered on commercial/strata sites where foot traffic is present	LOW
Slips on wet surfaces	Slip and fall on the freshly-cleaned or wet surface	MEDIUM	Non-slip footwear worn; work sequenced to clean away from the exit path; wet-surface signage used on commercial and strata sites	LOW
Chemical pre-treatment	Skin/eye irritation from cleaning chemical contact	MEDIUM	SDS followed for all products; chemical-resistant gloves and eye protection worn during application; biodegradable products used throughout	LOW

6.3 Roof Cleaning, Gutter Cleaning & Solar Panel Cleaning

Task Step	Hazard / Risk	Rating	Control Measures	Residual
Accessing roof / gutter line	Fall from height — the most significant hazard in this service line	EXTREME	Ladder access only to gutter-line height, not onto roof sheeting, unless the roof pitch and access is confirmed safe; three points of contact maintained on ladders; ladders set on firm, level ground and footed or secured; work is not undertaken on steep-pitch or wet/slippery roofs; where safe access cannot be achieved with a ladder, the job is declined or referred for specialist height-safety equipment	MEDIUM
Working near overhead powerlines	Electrocution from contact between equipment/ladder and powerlines	EXTREME	Visual check for overhead powerlines before any elevated work; minimum safe approach distances maintained per WHS Regulation requirements; work is not undertaken where safe clearance cannot be confirmed	LOW
Fragile roofing materials	Fall through skylights, deteriorated sheeting or fragile roof sections	HIGH	Roof condition visually assessed before access; work confined to structurally sound sections; fragile areas avoided and reported to the customer rather than worked on	LOW
Gutter debris removal	Cuts from sharp gutter edges or debris; exposure to bird/vermin droppings	MEDIUM	Cut-resistant gloves worn; hand hygiene after the task; debris bagged and removed rather than left on-site	LOW
Solar panel cleaning	Electric shock from panel/array components; falls associated with roof-level access as above	HIGH	Panels cleaned using non-conductive tools and water only (no contact with wiring, isolators or junction boxes); roof-access controls above applied; work deferred where the array's isolation/condition cannot be visually confirmed as safe	LOW
Weather conditions	Increased fall and electrical risk in wind, rain or storm conditions	HIGH	Elevated work is not undertaken in rain, high wind, or when a storm is forecast for the work period; job rescheduled where conditions are unsuitable	LOW

6.4 House Washing, Soft Washing & Window Cleaning

Task Step	Hazard / Risk	Rating	Control Measures	Residual
Extension pole / low-level ladder use	Fall or strain from overreaching with poles or ladders	MEDIUM	Ladder set up on firm, level ground; overreaching avoided by repositioning rather than stretching; extension poles used for upper-level glass and walls in preference to ladder access where practical	LOW

Task Step	Hazard / Risk	Rating	Control Measures	Residual
Soft-wash chemical application	Skin/eye/respiratory irritation from low-pressure chemical treatment	MEDIUM	SDS followed; chemical-resistant gloves and eye protection worn; application avoided in windy conditions to limit chemical drift; biodegradable, surface-appropriate products used	LOW
Broken glass (window cleaning)	Cuts from existing cracked or damaged glass	LOW	Glass condition checked before cleaning; damaged panes reported to the customer rather than worked on; gloves worn where damage is present	LOW
Working near garden beds / delicate landscaping	Chemical runoff affecting plants; property damage	LOW	Runoff directed away from garden beds where practical; biodegradable products minimise plant impact; customer consulted on sensitive landscaping before starting	LOW

7. Emergency Procedures

- In a medical emergency: stop work immediately, apply first aid within trained capability, call 000 for ambulance, and notify the customer/site contact
- In the event of a fall, electric shock, or serious incident on a commercial or strata site: stop work, secure the area, notify the site principal contractor or manager, and follow the site's own emergency procedure in addition to this SWMS
- All incidents and near-misses are recorded and reviewed to determine whether this SWMS requires updating
- Notifiable incidents are reported to Workplace Health and Safety Queensland as required under the Work Health and Safety Act 2011

8. Training & Competency

Siezar Fransiscus Dewaal holds practical experience across all services listed in this SWMS. Any additional worker engaged is briefed on this SWMS, site-specific hazards, correct PPE use, and safe operation of pressure washing and access equipment before being permitted to work unsupervised. Competency is reviewed prior to any worker being assigned roof, gutter or solar panel access tasks specifically, given the elevated risk rating of that work.

9. Review & Sign-Off

This SWMS has been prepared based on the current scope of services offered by Cairns Bin Cleaning as at the date issued. It is reviewed annually, before any site-specific job presenting hazards not addressed above, and immediately following any incident or near-miss.

Prepared by	Signature	Date
Siezar Fransiscus Dewaal		16 / 09 / 2026

Note: this SWMS is a working safety document prepared for Cairns Bin Cleaning's own operations and for client/procurement reference. It is not a substitute for independent WHS advice — for use on higher-risk sites (government, industrial, or multi-storey commercial), Cairns Bin Cleaning recommends this document be reviewed against the specific site's WHS management plan before work begins.